CivicClear | Municipal Readiness Report

CIVIC Hack 2026 • City of Toronto pilot • Prepared 12 November 2026 • Submission draft

01 Users and civic value

CivicClear serves residents who cannot easily distinguish a staff **recommendation**, a **committee action** and a final **City Council decision**. Potential municipal users are the Clerk's Office, council staff, communications and public-engagement teams. A visitor selects an agenda item and optional ward to see a plain-language summary, its real decision stage, evidence links and participation caveats. This prevents “received for information” from being mistaken for project approval.

02 Data, staffing and operating workflow

Inputs are the City of Toronto TMMIS official agenda pages, supporting staff-report PDFs and adopted property-tax tables. The public demo includes four curated records and works without API credentials. An optional administrator-only Claude API workflow creates a structured card and a second cited explanation. Before release, a municipal reviewer must validate the **complete record**, committee/Council history, amendments, quotations, wards and dates. Host on approved infrastructure with documented update responsibilities, monitoring and source traceability.

03 Approximate costs

Cached demo lookups make no LLM calls. Published Claude Opus 5.5 prices reviewed 12 November 2026 were **USD $4 per million input tokens** and **$20 per million output tokens**; two document-processing calls may cost cents to dollars per item depending on report length. This is **an estimate, not a measured cost**; the paid API integration has not been exercised here. Account for reviewer time, hosting, technical upkeep, accessibility work and privacy/security assessment. A city-approved lower-cost model can be tested against a local accuracy benchmark.

04 Privacy and security

Although municipal agenda files are public, correspondence may contain individuals' names or contact details. The prototype removes named **Communications** and **Speakers** sections from pasted page text before sending to the model, and does not collect a resident's name, street address or account number. **This safeguard does not redact attached PDFs and is not a full privacy solution.** A production pilot needs a privacy impact assessment, manual PDF review, third-party processing approval, strong access control and an explicit data retention policy.

05 Resident-facing limitations and trust

AI explanations can be incomplete or wrong; **official decisions and current meeting notices always govern**. A committee vote is not automatically final Council approval. A requested future consultation does not establish current registration or a valid deadline. Unknown deadlines remain marked “not verified.” Ward membership indicates listed geography, not complete impact boundaries. The residential tax comparison assumes a constant assessed value and excludes education tax, rebates and fees; it does not predict a household's real bill.

06 Adaptation, inclusion and next pilot tests

A different municipality can replace its agenda sources, glossary, governance rules, tax tables and participation policy. Before rollout, validate representative local cases against clerk-reviewed golden answers; test mobile usability, source links, access controls and claims about meeting dates. Provide print-ready material, multilingual explanations and keyboard/screen-reader accessibility checks for people without reliable internet or English fluency. Final readiness depends on **independent human approval** of the four demo cards and real-world testing.

Evidence and methods: Toronto TMMIS agenda items 2026.DM41.4, 2026.PH29.2, 2026.PH29.1, 2026.CC38.1; 2025.CC27.1 for the prior-year rate. Toronto Have Your Say instructions and Claude model/pricing reference. Full links and AI disclosure: repository *docs/sources.md* and *docs/ai_usage.md*.